```
      "index.lifecycle.rollover_alias":"mysql-logs-alias"
    }
  }
}
```

Attaches an alias

We need to note a couple of things from this script. We must associate our previously defined index policy by setting it as `index.lifecycle.name` with this index template. Also, as the policy's definition has a hot phase with rollover defined, we must provide the `index.lifecycle.rollover_alias` name when creating this index template.

The final step is to create an index matching the index pattern defined in the index template, with a number as a suffix so rollover indexes are generated correctly. Note that we must define the alias and declare that the current index is writeable by setting `is_write_index` to `true`.

Listing 6.52 Setting the index as writable for the alias

```
PUT mysql-index-000001
{
  "aliases": {
    "mysql-logs-alias": {
      "is_write_index":true
    }
  }
}
```

Creates an index with the appropriate format

Enables the alias

The backing index must be writable.

Once we create the index, the policy kicks in. In our example, the index enters the hot phase, because `min_age` is set to 0 milliseconds, and then moves into the phase's `rollover` action. The index stays in this phase until one of the conditions (age, size of the index, or number of documents) is met. As soon as the condition is positive, the rollover phase is executed, and a new index `mysql-index-000002` is created (note the `index` suffix). The alias is remapped to point to this new index automatically. Then `mysql-index-000002` is rolled over to the `mysql-index-000003` index (again, if one of the conditions is met), and the cycle continues.

Policy scan interval

By default, policies are scanned every 10 minutes. To alter this scan period, we need to update the cluster settings using the `_cluster` endpoint.

When we are trying out lifecycle policies in development, a common problem is that none of the phases are executed. For example, although we set the phases' times (`min_age`, `max_age`) in milliseconds, none of the phases execute. If we are not aware of the scan interval, we may think the lifecycle policies are not being invoked—but the policies are waiting to be scanned.

We can reset the scan period by invoking the `_cluster/settings` endpoint with the appropriate period. For example, the following snippet resets the poll interval to 10 milliseconds: